

Res Gestae · Sect. I

Imperator divi filius Augustus.

A prima luce et in conspectu omnium se exercituum imperavit;

Post urbem Romae captam et religionis hostes victos,
socio se civitas, senatus, populusque Romanus esse voluit.

Res Gestae · Translation & Notes · Sect. I

The Emperor Augustus, son of the deified,

commanded from first light in the sight of all the armies;

After Rome had been captured and the enemies of religion defeated,
he wished to be treated as the ally of the state, senate, and Roman people.

Notes

Vocabulary:

Imperator: commander, later the official title of Roman emperors.

divi filius: "son of the deified" (postumus divus Augustus).

prima luce: ablative temporal, "at first light".

socio: accusative object of esse in mind of "to be a partner".

Grammar:

1. Ablative absolute: prima luce — time phrase "at first light".

2. Indirect statement implied: voluit + se esse soci(um).

3. Dative + esse (dativus commodi): civitas, senatus, populusque ...to be allied.

History:

1. Augustus frames his achievements in piety and military success.

2. Sets tone for Res Gestae: legitimacy through divine descent, consensus.

3. "Senatus populusque Romanus" (SPQR) as constitutional veneer.